A-A-370
October 1, 1985

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

RIBBON, COMPUTING AND RECORDING MACHINES

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Federal Specification DDD-R-271.

This commercial item description covers woven cotton and nylon fabric computing and recording machine ribbons.

Salient characteristics.

Weave.
The fabric used shall have a regular commercial weave suitable for the purpose intended.

Edges.
Ribbon edges shall be straight and parallel with the warp threads. To prevent fraying, edges of cotton ribbons shall be woven or treated, and edges of nylon ribbons shall be fused.

Thickness and yarn count.
Ribbon thickness and yarn count shall be as indicated below. ASTM D 1777 shall be used to determine thickness. Edges will not be used to determine fabric thickness.

Composition	Thickness (inches)	Total Yarn Count	Minimum Warp	Minimum Fill
		Threads Per Square Inch	Threads Per Inch	Threads Per Inch
Cotton	0.0058 (Min)	258 - 270	132	126
Nylon	0.0048-0.0052	272 - 286	164	108

Color.
Ribbons shall be single-color or two-color as specified. Two-color ribbons shall have an equal width for each color, unless otherwise specified.

Inking.
Ribbons shall be evenly inked. The division of two-color ribbons shall be clearly delineated, and neither color shall bleed into the other prior to or during ribbon use.

Length.
Length shall be as specified and shall not be shorter than one-half inch for each yard of ribbon. Ribbons shall be furnished in continuous lengths without joining or splicing.

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Width.
Ribbon width shall be as specified. A tolerance of plus 1/64 inch and minus 0.0 inch shall be permitted, provided print quality and ribbon operation are not affected.

Spools, cartridges, and cores.
Each ribbon shall be furnished on a metal or plastic spool, cartridge, or core for the specified machine. Metal, except aluminum, shall have an enamel, lacquer, or plated finish. Each ribbon shall be designed to operate satisfactorily with the ribbon feed and reversing mechanisms of the machine specified.

Performance.
When used on the designated machine model, ribbons shall produce clear, clean, and legible type impressions. There shall be no evidence of type filling. Typefilling is the filling of the type face with fibers or ink from the ribbon, resulting in gradual broadening or feathering of typed impressions. There shall be no evidence of oil staining when ribbon impressions are examined. This performance shall be capable of being validated with a 5 hour test, at a minimum typing speed of 40 words per minute.

Workmanship.
Ribbons and their spools, cartridges, or cores shall be free from all defects that will affect performance and serviceability, or present a hazard to the user. Examples of ribbon defects are uneven weave, frayed edges, slits, and knots.

Regulatory requirements.
In accordance with section 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulations, the Government's policy is to acquire items composed of the highest percentage of recovered materials practicable, consistent with maintaining a satisfactory level of competition without adversely affecting performance requirements or exposing suppliers' employees to undue hazards from the recovered materials.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.
The preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

NOTES.
Purchasers shall indicate length, width, and thickness in the purchase order.

Purchasers shall indicate the manufacturer's name and the model number of the machine on which the ribbon will be used.

When this commercial item description is used for procurement, the commercial item certification clause must appear in the solicitation.

ASTM standards are available from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DoD has determined that no military activity has an official interest in this commercial item description.

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

NONE.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

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